

UPWORK PORTFOLIO CASE STUDY

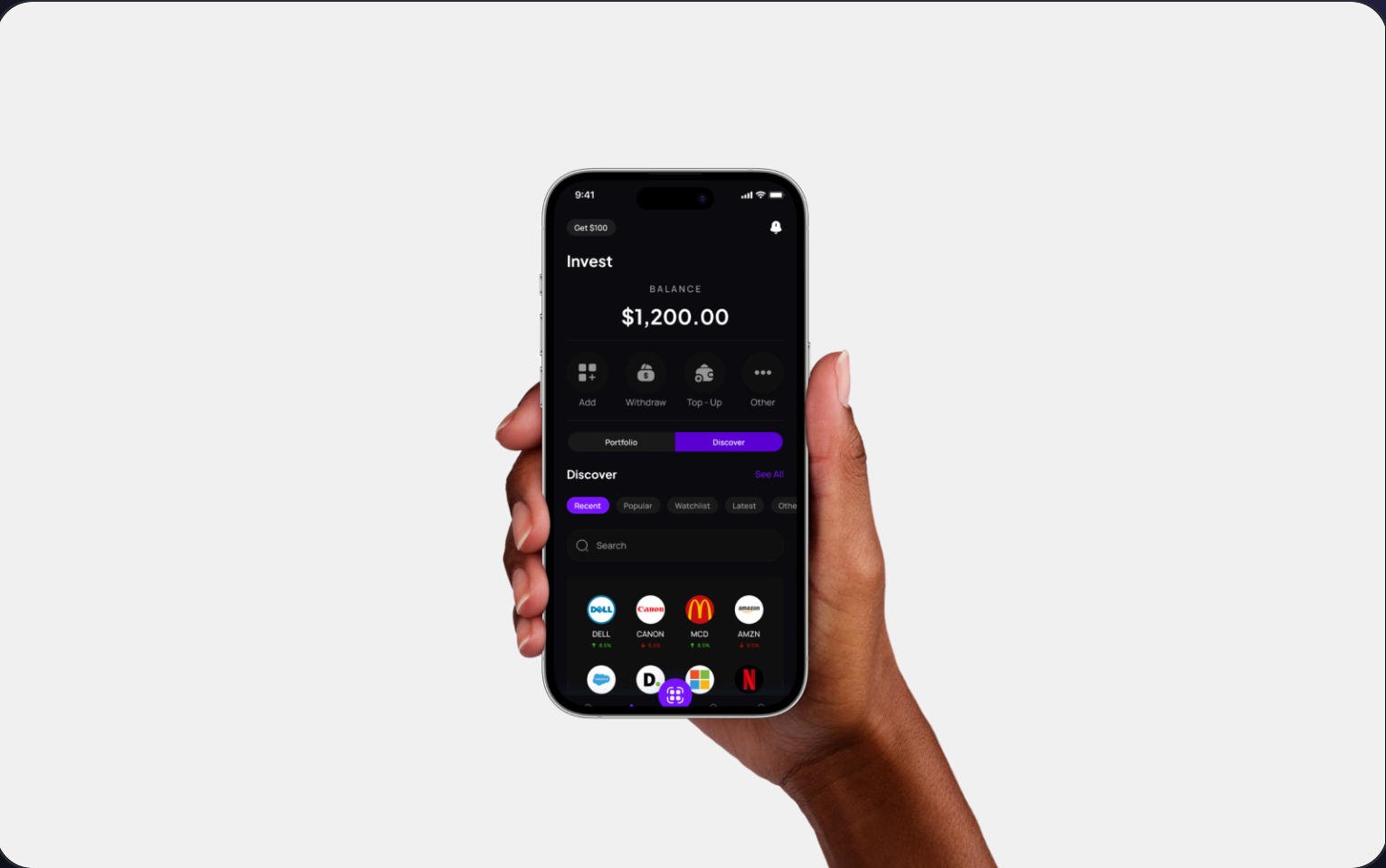
Spot Finance

Investing, Saving and Paying in One Consumer Fintech App

Most people who want to start investing are not short of options—they are short of confidence. While comfortable with basic banking apps, prospective investors are intimidated by the jargon of trading terminals: tickers, spreads, and order books. Spot Finance unified fractional stock investing, automated savings, and everyday payments into one approachable app.

ROLE & SCOPE Senior Product Designer	ENGAGEMENT & TIMELINE Contract · 5 Months (2023)
CLIENT / ORGANIZATION Spot Finance (Consumer Fintech)	KEY DELIVERABLES Mobile App (iOS/Android), Design System, User Research & Flows

4.9★ App Store Rating	120K+ Active User Base	15 Days Research & Usability Testing	5 Mos Timeline to Handover
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■ PROBLEM FRAMING

The Challenge & Friction Points

Consolidation is easy to propose and difficult to design. Payments, savings, and investments have distinct psychological rhythms: payments are instant and transactional; savings are passive and routine; investments carry risk and anxiety. Placing them behind one tab bar carelessly risks either trivializing investing or making paying for coffee stressful.

◆ Target User Segments & Stakeholders

Alex, 28 (Software Engineer)

Financially capable, values minimal clean UI, wanted fractional investing in tech brands without learning technical trading terminals.

Emma, 25 (Marketing Exec)

Focused on aesthetics and effortless automated savings; wanted simple visual performance tracking without jargon.

■ STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Core Design Principles

01 One Account, Three Behaviours

Home, Invest, Savings, and Profile share a single balance spine. Moving funds between them is a simple internal transfer, not a migration into a separate product.

02 Recognition Before Research

The Discover grid leads with familiar brand logos (Apple, Amazon, Nike, Netflix) because first-time investors search for companies they know, not ticker symbols.

03 Security That Stays Out of the Way

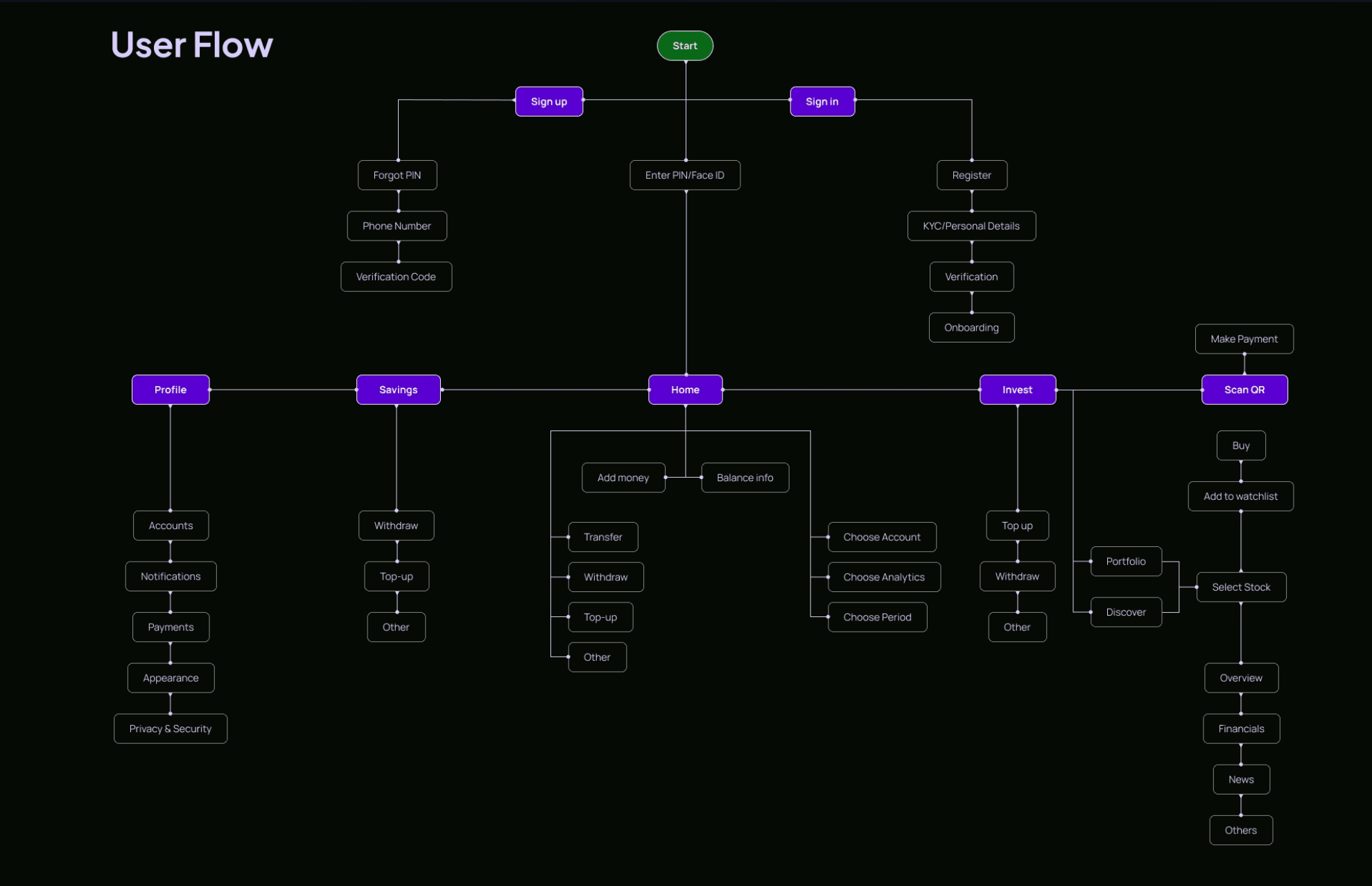
Two-factor and biometric authentication guard session entry and money-moving actions, protecting the user at the moments that matter without friction on passive browsing.

STRATEGIC INSIGHT

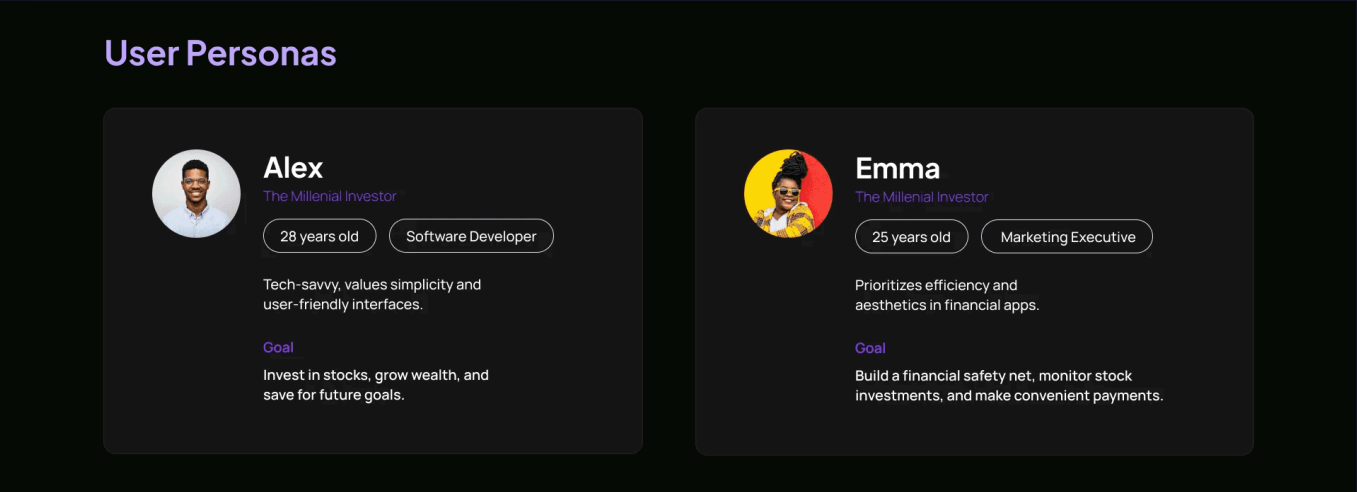
"Consolidation is primarily an information hierarchy problem. What made Spot Finance feel unified was establishing a single balance spine and building the comprehensive component library before drawing screens."

■ SYSTEM BLUEPRINTS

Unified Product Architecture & User Flow



Full user flow showing how spending, saving, and investing branch from one authenticated root with shared security checkpoints.



User personas (Alex & Emma) against whom every interaction and information density decision was benchmarked.

◆ **Single Balance Spine**

Unified liquidity model allows users to invest spare change or withdraw investment gains to debit accounts seamlessly.

◆ **Approachability First**

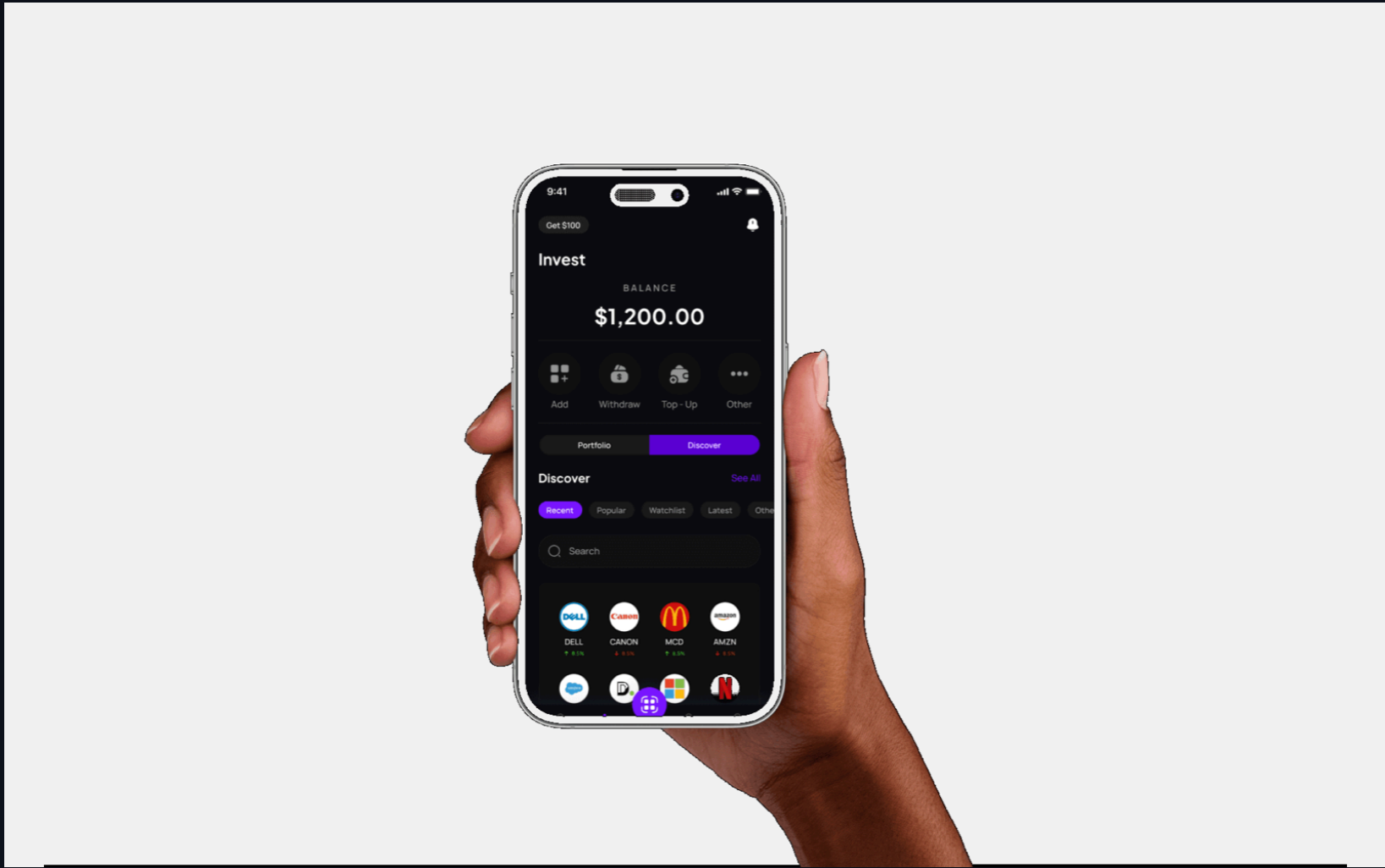
Replaced traditional order books with simplified "Buy / Sell" amounts and clear 1D to 5Y performance charts.

◆ **Integrated Scan-to-Pay**

Positioned QR payment as a first-class feature on the navigation bar, driving daily transactional habit and engagement.

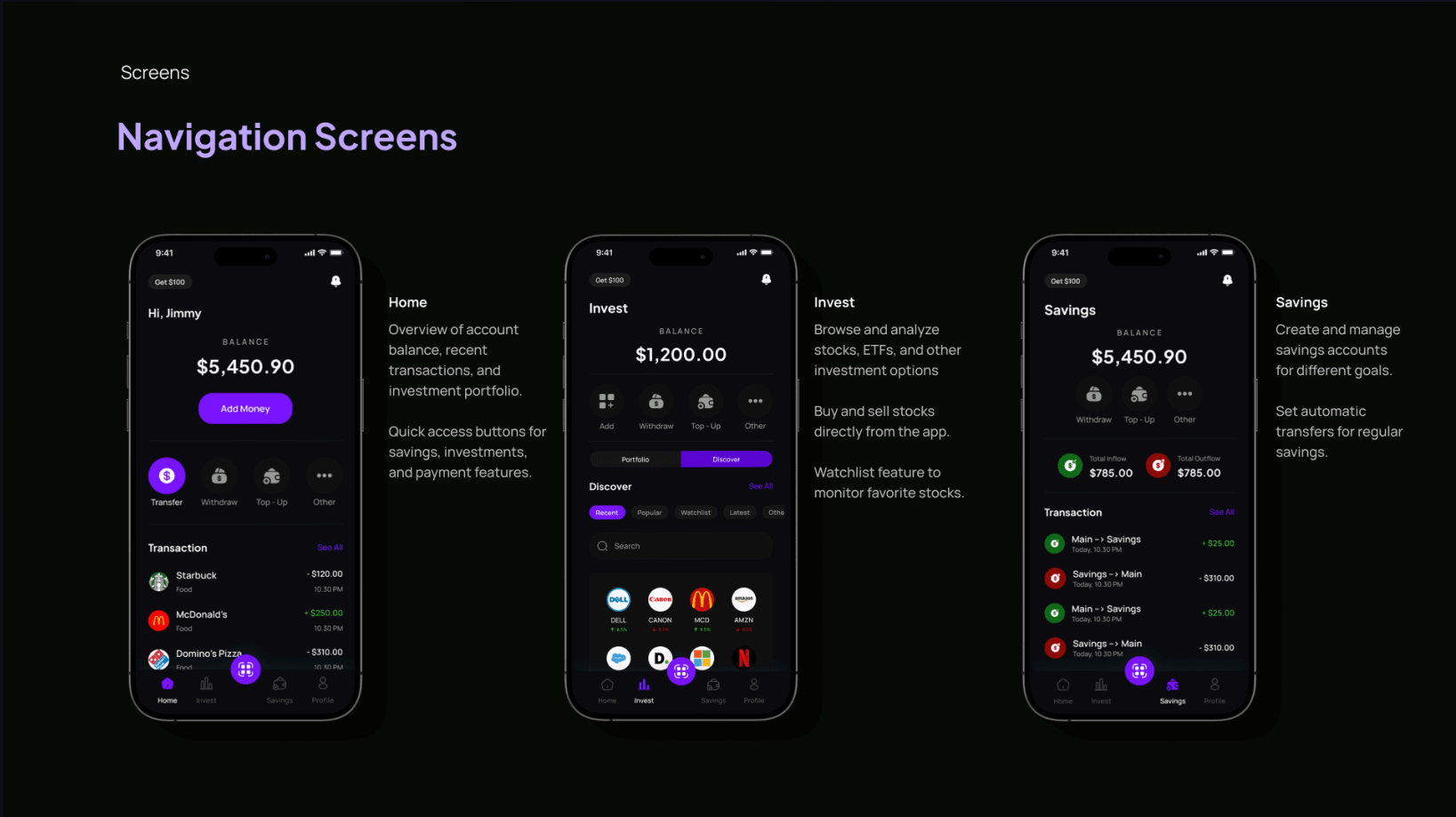
■ INTERFACE HIGHLIGHTS

Core Product Experience & Touchpoints



● **Discover Investing by Recognition**

Brand-first Discover grid categorized by Popular, Recent, and Top Movers, lowering intimidation for novice retail investors.



● **One Account, Three Behaviours**

Home, Invest, and Savings sit on a single navigation bar with a shared balance, making money movement an internal transfer rather than an app switch.

■ SCALABLE FOUNDATIONS

Tokens, States & Parity

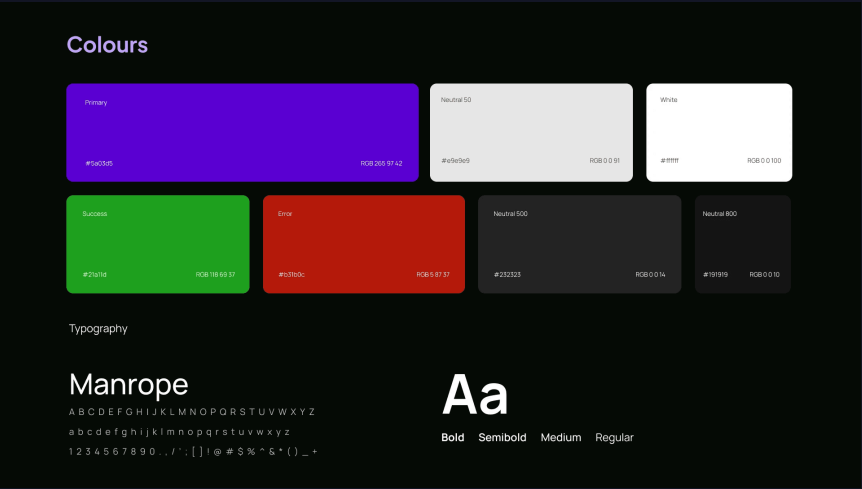
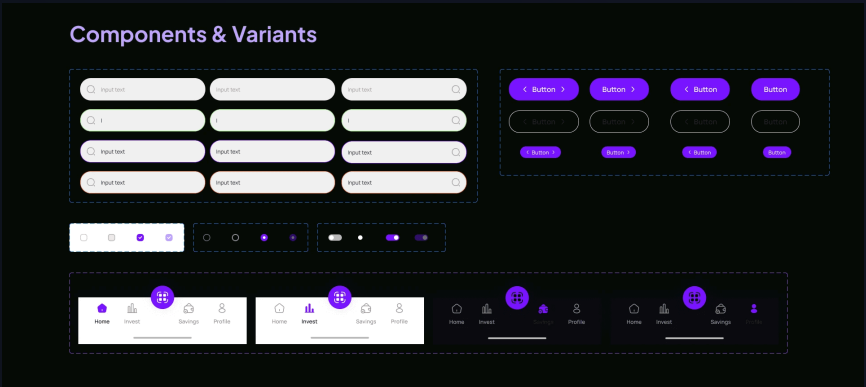
A dark-first component system built with a signature violet accent. Features comprehensive component states (inputs across 4 states, buttons across 3 sizes and 2 states, toggles, checkboxes, tab bars) designed with 100% parity across light and dark modes.

◆ System Specifications

- ✓ Comprehensive component library with full dark and light mode parity
- ✓ Text fields across 4 states (Default, Active, Error, Filled)
- ✓ Disciplined color palette: violet for primary action, green/red strictly for gains and losses
- ✓ Standardized 8pt grid spacing and accessible contrast ratios throughout

THE DESIGN ENGINEER ADVANTAGE

Bridging the gap between Figma and production front-end code (React, Next.js, TypeScript). Zero guesswork during developer handoff, pixel-perfect responsive execution, and bulletproof component architectures.



BUSINESS & USER IMPACT

Shipped Outcomes & Measured Results

4.9 ★

APP STORE RATING

120K+

ACTIVE USER BASE

15 Days

RESEARCH & USABILITY TESTING

5 Mos

TIMELINE TO HANDOVER

◆ Validated Project Milestone

Shipped to a 4.9★ App Store rating across 120,000+ active users. Delivered a production-ready component library and design system that accelerated engineering delivery.

◆ Senior Product Reflections

"Consolidation is a hierarchy challenge, not a feature challenge. Sticking to a single balance and authenticating at the two crucial checkpoints gave users freedom without compromising security. Building components first allowed light and dark parity to become a natural property of the system."

JA

Jimmy Arikawe

Senior Product Designer & Design Engineer · Ex-Pentagram

AVAILABLE ON UPWORK

◆ End-to-End Product Design (0 to 1)

◆ Design Systems & Component Libraries

◆ Complex SaaS & Enterprise Dashboards

◆ Design Engineering (React / Next.js / TS)

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